

Agile

Agile is **NOT** a development process
It is a **philosophy** - a way of thinking

The Agile "Manifesto" promotes the following values:

- Individuals & Interactions (over processes & tools)
- Operational Software (over documentation)
- Customer Collaboration (over formal contracts)
- Responding to Change (over predefined plan)

How to take these

- These can make old-school devs very nervous !
- Values are however intended as "provocations"...
- Get us to rethink and reassess our preconceptions
- They don't ask us to totally disregard certain things (such as processes, tools, documentation etc)
- But rather, think about other aspects AS WELL

Agile is a development methodology
devised by (and for use by) coders !

so...

What things do coders like ?

Likes

- Writing high quality code (yay !!!)
- Refactoring code to make it more “elegant”
- Ticking things off to-do list: closure on work done
- Showing results to client to impress them

Dislikes

- Eliciting and recording requirements
- Writing tedious documentation
- Committing to a final design in advance
- Managers telling them how to work
- Big and immovable deadlines

12 Principles of Agile

- Satisfying customer's needs
(with early & continuous delivery of SW)
- Embracing change
(even late on in the development cycle)
- Delivering working SW regularly
(and frequently e.g. monthly/weekly)
- Developer and client daily collaboration
- Trusting motivated individuals
- Ensuring face-to-face communication

12 Principles of Agile (continued)

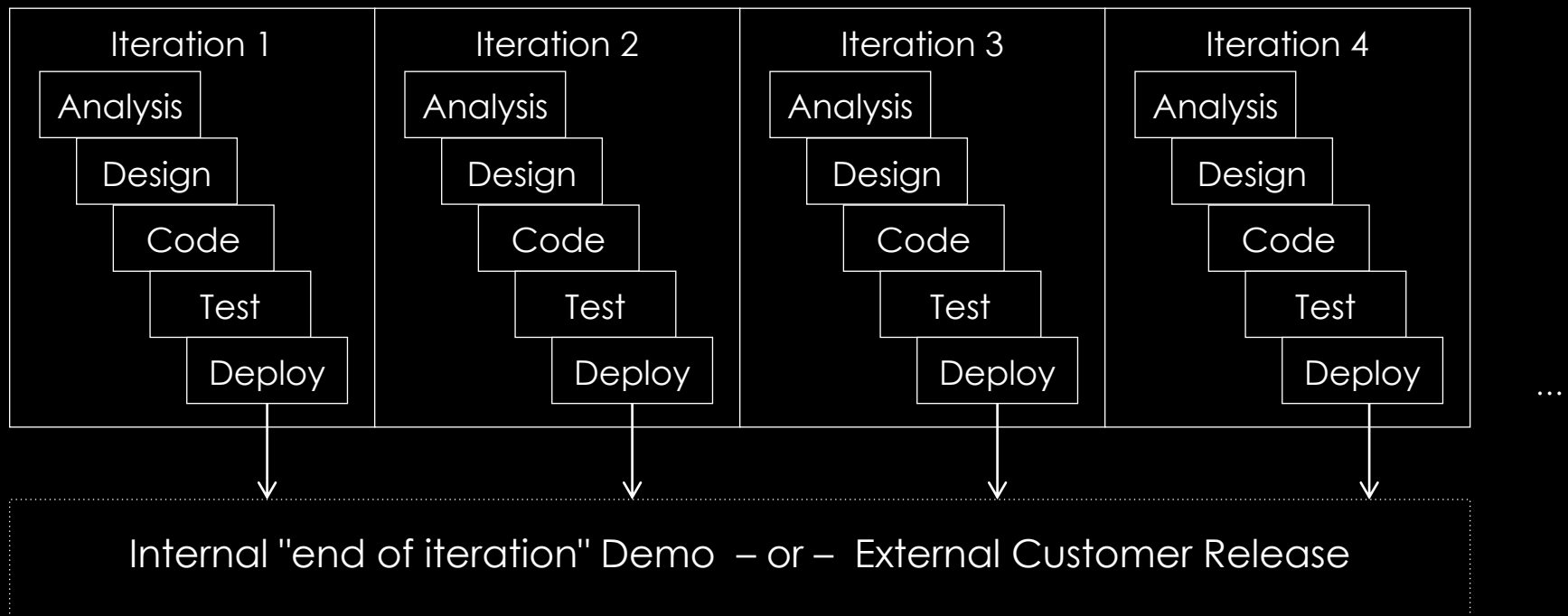
- Measuring progress by amount of working code
- Working at constant & sustainable pace
(not relying on heroic effort)
- Continuous attention to technical excellence
- Simplicity: minimise amount of (unnecessary) work
- Rely upon self-organising teams
- Teams regularly reflect on their own performance

Agile in Perspective

- Many elements of Agile are not new
- They have existed and evolved for many years
- Agile draws them together under a single umbrella

- If you were being really cynical you might view Agile as just a branding exercise
- An opportunity to sell more books
- Earn more consultancy fees ;o)

The “Totally new” Agile Approach



“Old Fashioned” Generic Waterfall

